

REPORTS, DASHBOARDS AND UI BUILDER

Aim:

To create reports, dashboards, and customize the user interface (UI) using the UI Builder in Zoho Creator, in order to visualize, analyze, and present application data effectively for end users.

Procedure:

1. Sign in to Zoho Creator

- Open a browser and go to `creator.zoho.com`.
- Log in with a valid Zoho account.
- Open the application in which the forms and data models have already been created.

2. Creating Reports

- Navigate to the application and click **Add Report**.
- Select the Form on which the report should be based (the report pulls data from the associated form).
- Choose the Report Type:
 - **List View** - displays records in a tabular/grid format.
 - **Kanban View** - displays records as cards grouped by a field (e.g., status).
 - **Calendar View** - displays date-based records on a calendar.
 - **Map View** - displays location-based records on a map.
 - **Timeline View** - displays records against a time scale.
 - **Pivot View / Chart View** - for summarized/analytical data.
- Give the report a suitable Report Name.
- Click **Create**.
- Customize the report:
 - Select which fields/columns to display.
 - Apply Criteria/Filters to show only specific records (e.g., Status = "Active").
 - Set Sorting order (ascending/descending) based on a field.
 - Group records using the Group By option if required.
 - Add Quick Filters or Search fields for end-user convenience.
 - Save the report.

3. Creating Dashboards

- Go to the Dashboards section of the application and click **Add Dashboard Component**.
- Choose the type of dashboard component:
 - Chart (Bar, Line, Pie, Column, Donut, etc.)
 - Aggregate/KPI (single value summary, e.g., Total Sales)
 - Table/Grid component
- Select the Data Source (the form/report on which the dashboard is based).
- Configure the X-axis and Y-axis (or grouping and value fields) for the chart.
- Apply filters/criteria if only specific data should be visualized.
- Set the Title, Color Theme, and Legend for clarity.
- Arrange multiple components on the dashboard canvas using drag-and-drop to build a complete analytical dashboard.
- Save and preview the dashboard.

4. UI Builder — Customizing the User Interface

- Go to the Pages section and click **Add Page** (or use the built-in UI Builder).
- Choose a Blank Page or a suitable Page Template.
- Use the drag-and-drop UI Builder to add components onto the page:
 - Forms (to allow data entry)
 - Reports (to display records)
 - Dashboard components (charts/KPIs)
 - Static elements: Text labels, Images, Buttons, Menus, Tabs
- Arrange the components using the grid layout for a clean, responsive design.
- Set actions/navigation for buttons (e.g., link a button to open a form or navigate to another page).
- Customize the theme: colors, fonts, logo, and header/footer, to match branding requirements.
- Set access permissions/roles to control which users can view/edit each page or component.

5. Preview and Test

- Click **Preview** to view the reports, dashboard, and custom pages as an end user would see them.
- Test filters, sorting, navigation buttons, and links to confirm they function as intended.
- Check the dashboard/report on different devices (desktop/mobile) for responsiveness.

6. Publish/Deploy

- Once verified, click **Publish** to deploy the application.
- Share the application link or grant user access so that end users can view reports, interact with dashboards, and use the custom UI pages.

Screenshots:

Academic Record List Report

Result:

Thus, reports and a customized user interface were successfully created and configured in Zoho Creator using the UI Builder. Various report views (List, Kanban, Calendar, Spreadsheet) and a user-friendly custom UI page with proper navigation, theming, and access control were designed, tested, and deployed successfully.